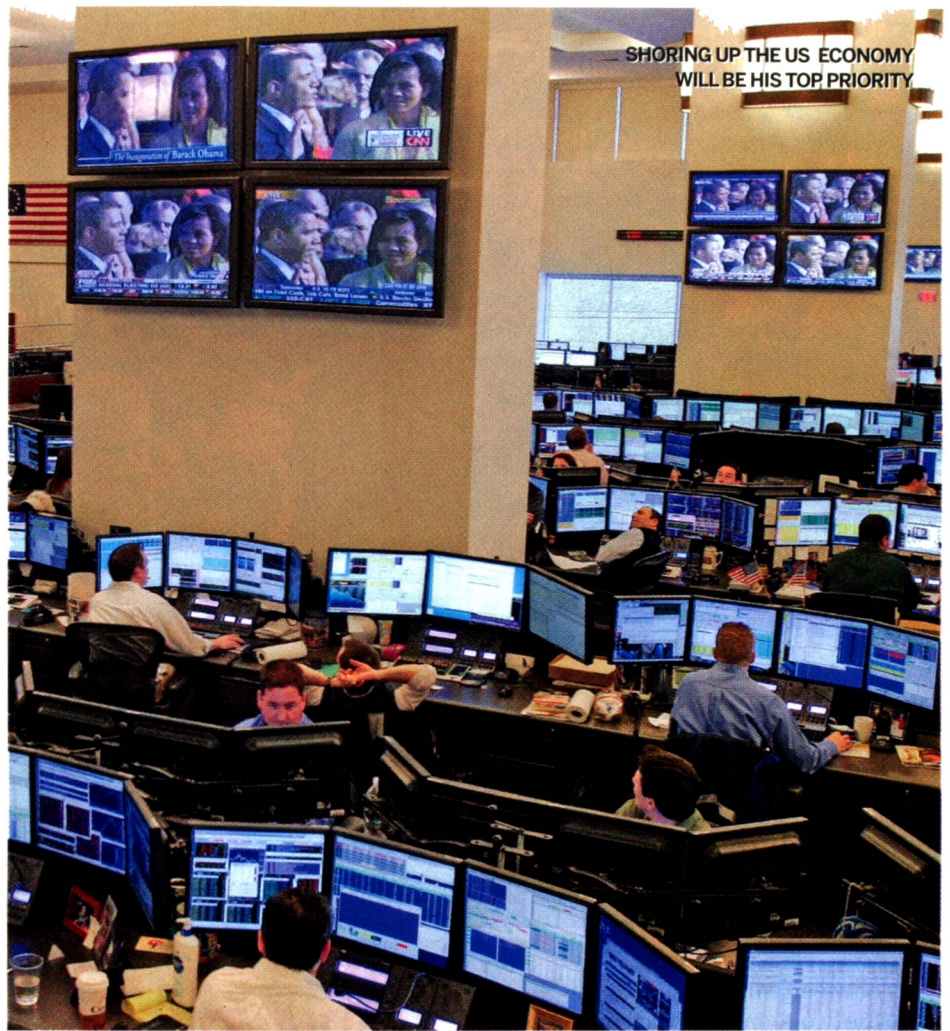


Delhi viewed the appointment of Hillary positively because along with Bill she has maintained close links with India after he left the Oval office and she joined the Senate. During the campaign, Obama supporters even twitted her for being a "Punjabi." Now handling the second most powerful post in the administration, Hillary seems to have fitted in well talking of America using "smart power, the full range of tools at our disposal—diplomatic, economic, military, political, legal and cultural." In her Senate testimony, Clinton seemed committed to Obama's goal of establishing "a true strategic partnership with India, increasing our military co-operation, trade and support for democracies around the world. As our relationship deepens, the United States and India can work together to address global and regional problems of shared concern." That is a very encouraging beginning for India.

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WHAT CAN THE US DO FOR INDIA'S ECONOMY?

During Bush's tenure the nuclear deal and its consummation sucked up vast amounts of energy leaving very little time for anything else. But as Sen points out, "The nuclear deal is a key that opened a door to a room that led to the opening of more doors and windows in other rooms. It is now up to both countries to realise the full potential of their relationship." With US economy wobbling and India experiencing a downturn the two could work together in myriad ways to boost trade well beyond the \$41 billion figure. The USIBC is pushing for a bilateral investment treaty that could set the stage for greater two-way investment between the US and India. Ron Somers, USIBC president, says, "We need to value one another's strengths and leverage these positive synergies." As an example he points out that India wishes to sell more of its high-end

services to US companies and in turn American companies value India's vast markets for high-end manufactured goods. The US is also pushing for a successful conclusion of the WTO talks at Doha and the Obama administration hopes India will back it.

There are new areas in which trade between the two countries can be boosted. The Obama administration talks of America tak-

ing on its responsibility of cleaning up the environment and investing heavily on clean technology. India needs such technology and should proactively move towards the latest in the business as it did in the telecom business. The US Defence industry is opening out to India with the lifting of strictures on sale of certain hi-tech equipment. That should yield a whole new universe for growth. So too would joint ven-

WITH THE US ECONOMY WOBBLING AND INDIA FARING NO BETTER, THE TWO COUNTRIES SHOULD TRY AND PUSH TRADE BEYOND THE \$41 BILLION MARK.